

Metro Atlanta Storm Roof Check: What to Inspect Before Rain

Heavy rain and thunderstorms are moving through Metro Atlanta this weekend, with forecasters at CBS News Atlanta tracking when the heaviest storms will hit and how a weak front will affect the region (Source: [cbsnews.com](https://www.cbsnews.com), July 2026). For homeowners with roofs installed in the 1990s or early 2000s - common across Cobb, Gwinnett, and DeKalb subdivisions - a single wind-driven downpour can expose aging flashing, worn shingles, and clogged gutters before you ever see a ceiling stain. Knowing what to inspect before and after the rain is the difference between a minor fix and a costly interior leak.

The short answer: Before heavy rain, check your shingles, flashing, gutters, and attic for existing weak points; after the storm, look for lifted shingles, granule buildup, and any signs of water intrusion so small problems don't become expensive water damage.

Who this affects: Metro Atlanta homeowners with aging asphalt roofs - especially 1980s-90s tract homes in Marietta, Roswell, and Lawrenceville and older frame construction in Decatur and Tucker.

What to do: Complete a ground-level and attic inspection before the front arrives, then document any post-storm changes with dated photos.

Timeline: Before the next round of storms this season, and again at your annual professional roof inspection.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspections to identify granule loss, lifted shingles, and flashing failures that a ground-level visual routinely misses on steep or multi-story Atlanta homes.

What should Metro Atlanta homeowners inspect before a thunderstorm?

Before heavy rain arrives, inspect your shingles, flashing, gutters, and attic for existing vulnerabilities that a storm will expose. CBS News Atlanta is forecasting heavy rain and thunderstorms across the region, with the heaviest activity tied to a passing front (Source: [cbsnews.com](https://www.cbsnews.com), July 2026). In Metro Atlanta, wind-driven rain finds the weakest point first - typically deteriorated flashing around chimneys and vents, or lifted shingles on the windward slope. Homes in older Smyrna and Vinings neighborhoods with original 20-to-25-year architectural shingles are especially prone to this because the sealant strips lose their grip as shingles age. Take dated photos of your roofline from the ground now, so you have a clear before-storm baseline if damage occurs.

Why does Atlanta's storm timing matter for roof leaks?

Storm timing matters because sustained, heavy rainfall - not a brief shower - is what drives water through compromised roofing layers. CBS News Atlanta reports the weekend system could bring the heaviest storms at specific windows as a weak front moves through, meaning prolonged saturation rather than a quick pass (Source: [cbsnews.com](https://www.cbsnews.com), July 2026). Metro Atlanta's April-through-September storm season concentrates this risk, and the region's mature tree canopy adds a second hazard: falling limbs. In Buckhead and Sandy Springs, where large hardwoods overhang steep-pitch roofs, a single dropped branch can puncture decking during a downpour.

Clear loose limbs where safely possible before the front arrives, and confirm gutters and downspouts are clear so water sheds away from the fascia and foundation.

What should you check on your roof after the storm passes?

After the storm passes, walk your property to look for lifted or missing shingles, granule accumulation in gutters and at downspout outlets, dented gutters or soffit, and any interior water stains. Wind-driven rain during Atlanta thunderstorms can break shingle seals without visibly removing the shingle - a hidden failure that only surfaces during the next rain. In Duluth and Suwanee subdivisions built during the 1990s housing boom, thousands of roofs share the same install date and are aging into their replacement window simultaneously, so post-storm inspection is worth doing even without obvious damage. Photograph anything unusual immediately with time stamps, and note the storm date; this documentation supports any future insurance claims and helps a contractor assess whether you need storm damage roof repair or a full roof replacement.

Which Metro Atlanta neighborhoods face the highest post-storm roof risk?

The highest post-storm roof risk falls on neighborhoods where housing stock age and tree exposure intersect with repeated storm cycles. In Marietta and Kennesaw, large 1980s and 1990s tract subdivisions carry roofs at or beyond their typical asphalt lifespan, making shingle seal failure and granule loss common after heavy rain. Decatur and Tucker feature older postwar frame homes where original flashing details around chimneys and dormers frequently leak once the surrounding materials weather. Across Roswell, Johns Creek, and Alpharetta, steep-pitch two-story homes under dense hardwood canopy face elevated impact risk from falling limbs during thunderstorms - and their height makes safe ground inspection difficult, which is exactly where an AI-powered drone inspection captures what a homeowner cannot safely reach. In Lawrenceville and Norcross, dense 1990s development means neighbor-to-neighbor roofs reach end-of-life together, so a storm that damages one often reveals wear across the block. If you own in any of these areas, prioritize an attic check for daylight, damp insulation, or musty odor after the next storm.

How do aging shingles turn a routine storm into water damage?

Aging shingles turn routine rain into water damage because their protective granules wear away and their sealant bond weakens, leaving the mat exposed and the shingle prone to wind lift. Once a shingle loses its seal, wind-driven rain - the kind CBS News Atlanta is forecasting this weekend - pushes moisture beneath the surface and into the underlayment and decking (Source: [cbsnews.com](https://www.cbsnews.com), July 2026). Deferred maintenance compounds the problem: cracked flashing, clogged gutters, and worn pipe boots each create an entry point that a healthy roof would resist. On a 20-plus-year roof in East Cobb or Chamblee, these small failures often occur together, which is why a professional roof inspection matters more than a quick glance from the driveway. As a GAF Master Elite certified contractor - a designation held by only a small fraction of U.S. roofers - Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors installs CertainTeed and GAF systems backed by factory manufacturer warranties that standard installs cannot match.

What does storm roof risk look like by Metro Atlanta area and housing type?

Storm roof risk varies by neighborhood because housing era and tree exposure determine which failure comes first. The table below connects common Metro Atlanta housing types to their storm vulnerability and the single most useful action for each.

Area	Housing Type / Era	Storm Vulnerability	Homeowner Action
Marietta / Kennesaw	1980s-90s tract subdivisions	Shingles at/near end of lifespan; seal failure in wind-driven rain	Attic check for damp insulation; photo-document shingle condition
Decatur / Tucker	Postwar frame homes	Aging chimney and dormer flashing leaks	Inspect flashing seams; look for interior stains after rain
Roswell / Johns Creek / Alpharetta	1990s-2000s steep two-story under canopy	Falling-limb impact; hard-to-inspect height	Clear overhanging limbs; use drone inspection for steep slopes
Lawrenceville / Norcross	Dense 1990s development	Block-wide roofs aging together	Compare roof condition after storm; document granule loss
East Cobb / Chamblee	20+ year architectural shingles	Combined flashing and gutter failures	Professional inspection before replacement decision

What should you do if you find storm damage on your roof?

If you find storm damage, document it thoroughly with dated photos before touching anything, then arrange a professional roof inspection to confirm the extent. Interior stains, lifted shingles, and granule piles all indicate the roof's protective layer has been compromised and needs assessment. Metro Atlanta homeowners filing insurance claims benefit most from clear before-and-after documentation, which is why baseline photos taken ahead of the storm are so valuable. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors provides insurance claims assistance, helping homeowners in Cobb, Gwinnett, and Fulton counties document damage and navigate the claims process alongside their adjuster. When repair costs run high, Wells Fargo financing options can spread the cost of storm damage restoration or a full roof replacement.

FAQ

What should I check on my roof before this weekend's Atlanta storms?

Check your shingles for lifting or curling, your flashing around chimneys and vents for gaps, and your gutters for clogs before the rain arrives. CBS News Atlanta is forecasting heavy rain and thunderstorms tied to a passing front, so clearing gutters and downspouts now helps water shed away from your fascia and foundation. Also take dated ground-level photos of each roof slope to create a before-storm baseline. If you spot obvious wear you cannot safely reach, schedule a professional inspection.

Can wind-driven rain damage my roof even if no shingles blow off?

Yes - wind-driven rain can break a shingle's sealant bond without removing the shingle, creating a hidden leak path. This is especially common on aging roofs in areas like Smyrna and Vinings where original sealant strips have weakened over 20-plus years. The failure often stays invisible until the next rain pushes water beneath the surface. That's why a post-storm inspection matters even when your roof looks intact from the street.

My home in Marietta is from the 1990s - should I worry about my roof this storm season?

Yes, 1990s Marietta tract homes commonly carry roofs at or beyond the typical asphalt lifespan, making them prone to seal failure during heavy rain. Because entire subdivisions were built at once, many neighboring roofs reach end-of-life together. Do an attic check after storms for damp insulation, daylight through the decking, or a musty smell. If you find any of these signs, arrange a professional roof inspection to decide between repair and replacement.

How do I document roof storm damage for an insurance claim in Cobb County?

Document damage with dated, time-stamped photos of every affected area - lifted shingles, granule piles, dented gutters, and any interior stains - before making repairs. Keep the storm date noted alongside your before-and-after images, since baseline photos taken ahead of the storm strengthen your case. In Cobb County, adjusters rely heavily on clear visual evidence, so thorough documentation improves your outcome. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors can assist with organizing this documentation during the claims process.

Why is falling tree damage such a big roof risk in Buckhead and Sandy Springs?

Falling limbs are a major risk in Buckhead and Sandy Springs because mature hardwood canopy overhangs many steep-pitch, multi-story roofs. During thunderstorms like the one CBS News Atlanta is forecasting this weekend, a single dropped branch can puncture decking and expose the

interior to water. Clear loose or dead limbs where you can do so safely before the front arrives. After the storm, inspect for punctures, dents, and displaced shingles from any branch strikes.

When should I get a professional roof inspection instead of checking it myself?

Get a professional inspection when your roof is steep, multi-story, or hard to view safely from the ground, or when you suspect hidden damage after a storm. Many Roswell, Johns Creek, and Alpharetta homes are two stories under dense canopy, making a safe ground-level assessment nearly impossible. An AI-powered drone inspection captures granule loss, flashing failures, and lifted shingles across the whole roof with photo documentation. Schedule one at your annual inspection and again after any significant storm.

How do I know if I need a roof repair or a full replacement after storm damage?

You typically need a repair for isolated damage - a few lifted shingles or one damaged flashing section - and a full replacement when wear is widespread or the roof has passed its lifespan. On 20-plus-year roofs in East Cobb or Chamblee, storm damage often reveals that multiple systems are failing at once, tipping the decision toward replacement. A professional inspection quantifies the extent so you're not paying for repeated repairs on a roof near end-of-life. Ask your contractor to document both options with photos so you can compare costs.

Does Metro Atlanta's storm season make roof maintenance more important?

Yes, Metro Atlanta's April-through-September storm season concentrates heavy rain and wind that repeatedly stress aging roofs. Deferred maintenance - clogged gutters, cracked pipe boots, worn flashing - turns each storm into a potential leak, particularly on older frame homes in Decatur and Tucker. Regular gutter clearing, flashing checks, and an annual professional inspection keep small problems from becoming interior water damage. Treat maintenance as ongoing throughout the season, not a one-time task.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

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